

August 2026

Dear Satyanarayana,

I've been working in the Contra Costa hills long enough to know that a true single-story ranch on a 12,000 square foot lot in Walnut Creek doesn't come around very often, and 2037 Banbury Road caught my attention the moment it hit the market. Five bedrooms, mature redwoods in the backyard, solar panels, and a floor plan that genuinely lives as well as it photographs - this is exactly the kind of home that qualified buyers spend months trying to find. When the listing came off the market after 59 days without a sale, I wanted to reach out, because I don't think the home was the problem.

What the listing history suggests is a positioning gap, not a property gap. At \$665 per square foot, the home was priced at the lower end of Walnut Creek's range for an updated single-story ranch, which means the value case was genuinely strong - but the marketing didn't appear to build that case in a way that gave buyers the confidence to act. The listing description reads more like a checklist than a story. The features that would move a buyer - the scale of that backyard, the rare single-story five-bedroom floor plan, the mature redwoods, the solar - were mentioned but never given room to land. In a price range where buyers are comparing carefully, a listing that doesn't make them feel something tends to get scrolled past.

I've put together a short analysis for this property that walks through the three specific friction points I see in the listing record, a positioning comparison against current Walnut Creek inventory, and the approach I'd take to relaunch this home in a way that actually reaches the buyers who are looking for exactly what it offers. The packet lays out the strategy - and if any of it resonates, I'd welcome a conversation.

If you're already working with a real estate agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside - no need to read further. But if you're still weighing your options, I'd be glad to walk you through what I've prepared whenever it's convenient.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Ben Olsen', with a long horizontal line extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

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The Path to Sold:

2037 Banbury Road

WALNUT CREEK, CA 94598

5.0 Beds · 3 Baths · 2,784 Sq Ft · WALNUT CREEK

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 2037 Banbury Road

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Rare Single-Story Five-Bedroom Ranch on a 12,000 Sq Ft Lot - and a Listing That Didn't Show It

2037 Banbury Road has the combination of attributes that Walnut Creek buyers genuinely compete for: a true single-story layout with five bedrooms and three bathrooms, a 12,000 square foot lot with mature redwoods and a private landscaped backyard, solar panels, an oversized family room with fireplace, and a location within reach of BART, downtown Walnut Creek, and Heather Farm Park. Single-story homes at this square footage - 2,784 square feet - are rare in this market. A buyer who needs five bedrooms on one level doesn't have many alternatives.

The listing ran 59 days without a sale, which is long enough that buyer psychology had shifted from interest to skepticism before the home ever had a chance to convert its best prospects. At \$665 per square foot, the price was actually positioned at the low end of Walnut Creek's updated ranch range, meaning the value case was defensible and real. The failure wasn't in the fundamentals - it was in the strategy. The listing description introduced features without building a narrative around them, and the standard MLS approach placed the home passively in front of buyers who were browsing rather than actively surfacing it to qualified prospects who were ready to move.

\$1,849,999

List Price

\$665/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch for this property needs to do one specific thing: make the floor plan's rarity legible and make the backyard real to buyers before they ever schedule a showing. The goal is to find the buyer who has been searching for a single-story five-bedroom with this kind of outdoor space and give them a complete, immersive picture of what they'd be getting - not a photo grid and a checklist.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: 59 Days and No Pivot - Stale Listing Psychology Took Hold

Past the 45-day mark, buyer behavior changes in a way that doesn't recover on its own. Buyers stop evaluating a home on its merits and start asking what's wrong with it. At 59 days, 2037 Banbury Road had crossed that threshold, and the stigma was being built by the calendar, not by anything real about the property. A single-story five-bedroom ranch on a 12,000 square foot lot at \$665 per square foot doesn't need an explanation - it needs the right buyer to actually see it. The listing ran out of runway without a change in approach, and there was no visible pivot before it came off the market. The right strategy isn't to relist on the same path and hope the timing improves.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's off-market private buyer list at offmarket.brightworkrealty.com gives a relaunched home a clean starting point - reaching Bay Area buyers who have opted in specifically to see properties before anything accumulates days-on-market stigma on the public portals.

Friction #2: The Floor Plan's Rarity Was Never Made Visible

A 2,784 square foot single-story layout with five bedrooms is genuinely uncommon in Walnut Creek, and buyers who need that specific configuration - families with aging parents, buyers who won't do stairs, people who want a true guest suite on the same level - will pay a premium for it when they understand they're looking at something rare. The listing mentioned the floor plan but never demonstrated it. Buyers comparing this home against two-story alternatives on a portal couldn't feel the difference from a front-elevation photo and a paragraph. The visual story of how this floor plan actually lives - the scale of the rooms, the way they connect, the flow from the family room to the backyard - was never told.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

A 3D Matterport tour lets buyers walk the full floor plan from anywhere, any time - the kind of immersive experience that turns a browser into a scheduled showing, especially for out-of-area buyers and buyers who are seriously comparing floor plan options before they commit to a drive.

Friction #3: The Backyard and Its Mature Redwoods Were Listed, Not Sold

Mature redwoods, raised garden beds, and a private 12,000 square foot lot are not standard features in Walnut Creek - they're the kind of outdoor environment that justifies a price and drives emotional decisions. But the listing treated the backyard as a bullet point rather than a headline. Buyers who would have driven an hour for that backyard never knew what they were missing, because the marketing gave them no reason to believe it was extraordinary. Ground photography of a landscaped yard rarely captures scale, privacy, or the character that comes from decades of mature growth. The setting was undersold from the first impression.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Sky Tour gives buyers an aerial perspective that captures lot position, scale, and the surrounding canopy of mature redwoods in a way that no ground-level photo can replicate - turning the backyard from a description into something a buyer can actually experience before they visit.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	2037 Banbury Rd	Walnut Creek Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$665/sqft	Standard updated range: \$720–\$800/sqft
Lot / Setting	12,000 sq ft lot, mature redwoods, private landscaped backyard	Typical suburban lot, 6,000–8,500 sq ft
Architectural Character	Single-story Plambeck ranch, 1976, classic California form	Primarily two-story, split-level, and tract construction
Premium Features	5 bed / 3 bath single-story, oversized family room, solar panels, hardwood floors, granite kitchen	Standard 4-bed two-story, conventional finishes
HOA	None	None to \$150/mo depending on community

The verdict: At \$665/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$720-\$800/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$665 per square foot, 2037 Banbury Road was priced below the low end of Walnut Creek's standard updated range of \$720 to \$800 per square foot - meaning the home offered genuine value relative to market comparables. The gap between the fundamentals and the outcome wasn't a pricing problem. It was a marketing problem: the rarity of the floor plan, the scale of the lot, and the character of the outdoor space never translated into buyer urgency. A relaunch built around those specific assets, with the visual depth to match, changes that equation.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Make the Single-Story Floor Plan Legible and Irreplaceable

Five bedrooms on a single level at 2,784 square feet is a rare configuration in Walnut Creek, and the buyers who need it know exactly how hard it is to find. The relaunch strategy starts by making that rarity visible - not as a feature mentioned in passing, but as the organizing idea of the entire campaign. A 3D Matterport tour lets buyers walk the layout from anywhere before scheduling a showing, which means the people who drive out are already convinced. That's the difference between showings that convert and showings that don't.

Pillar II - Tell the Backyard's Story Before Buyers Walk Through the Gate

Mature redwoods, raised garden beds, and 12,000 square feet of private outdoor space are the kind of features that close deals - but only if buyers can experience them before they arrive. A Sky Tour aerial gives buyers the context to understand the lot's scale, the canopy, and the privacy that ground photography can't capture. The buyers who would pay a premium for this backyard need to know it exists and what it actually feels like before they'll make the drive. That's a marketing problem with a specific solution.

Pillar III - Reach the Right Buyers Before the Days-on-Market Clock Starts

A property with this floor plan and this lot doesn't need more exposure to casual browsers - it needs precise distribution to the buyers who have been searching for exactly this configuration and haven't found it yet. BrightWork's geo-targeted digital campaigns reach active buyers in San Francisco and the broader East Bay who are researching Lamorinda and Contra Costa before they've committed to a neighborhood. Paired with a clean off-market introduction before any public launch, the goal is to get serious, qualified buyers through the door before the listing ever accumulates a day of market skepticism.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

BrightWork Realty Advocates is a licensed real estate team operated by Ben Olsen, REALTOR, California DRE License #01409268. This communication is not intended to solicit properties currently listed for sale or under active representation.

The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

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THE BRIGHTWORK ADVANTAGE

- Buy Before You Sell
- BrightFlip Pre-Sale Improvements
- Final Offer Platform
- Zillow Showcase + homes.com Premium
- Off-Market Network
- Built to Close Clean

YOUR LISTING ADVISOR

Ben Olsen

Founding Partner | REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates · DRE# 02014153

Ben founded BrightWork on a specific premise: the best outcomes are built before a home ever lists. With twenty years serving the East Bay's most competitive submarkets, he's developed a clear point of view on what separates a sale that closes well from one that doesn't, and the preparation, marketing, and negotiation strategy to act on it.

He entered the workforce at 14 in construction, a background that shapes how he thinks about pre-sale decisions, disclosure strategy, and what buyers actually scrutinize at inspection. That's a different lens than most agents carry into a listing consultation.

His approach to marketing is built on the same logic. Every campaign is designed for your home's specific buyer, not the average buyer. Portal strategy, campaign integration, and buyer targeting aren't add-ons at BrightWork. They're the baseline. Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure before the home lists. The preparation is the negotiation.

20+

YEARS SERVING
LAMORINDA

\$1B+

PROPERTIES
SOLD

1,000+

BUYERS &
SELLERS

WHY HE SENT YOU THIS PACKET

When a listing expires, Ben reviews it. Not to pitch you, but because after enough of them, the pattern of what goes wrong becomes clear. If you received this analysis, he looked at your specific property and has a specific point of view about what happened. That's the conversation he's offering. No listing agreement on the table. Just a review. He'll also walk you through programs that turn seller constraints into options, and show you what a transaction designed to get everyone to the closing table feeling good actually looks like.

Why BrightWork Realty Advocates

Rooted in Lamorinda since 1977. BrightWork is built on the premise that the best outcomes start before a home ever lists. An orchestrated campaign designed for your home's buyer, not the average buyer. Programs that turn seller constraints into options. Transactions designed so everyone gets to the closing table feeling good.

That's The Smart Way to Real Estate.

EIGHT REASONS SMART SELLERS CHOOSE BRIGHTWORK

01

Superior Presentation

Professional photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not the luxury package. The baseline.

02

Premium Portal Presence

Zillow Showcase and premium homes.com membership. Higher view counts, better placement, and buyer inquiries that route to your listing team.

03

Integrated Campaigns

Every sign, mailer, and open house connects to a digital system. Curious neighbors become trackable leads.

04

Modern Offer Management

Real-time portal data guides pricing decisions. Final Offer platform for properties with strong multi-offer potential.

05

Financial Tools & Capital Programs

Capital to fund pre-sale improvements with no out-of-pocket cost until close. Plus programs that remove the timing trap entirely.

06

Off-Market Strategy

A private list of serious Bay Area buyers. Test demand quietly or gain early access before properties hit MLS.

07

Advocacy for Unsold Homes

When a home hasn't sold, we don't re-list at a lower price. We conduct a forensic review and relaunch with a rebuilt strategy.

08

Built to Close Clean

Pre-sale prep, real fixes, and full disclosure to every buyer before the house lists. He structures listings to attract the best first offers from a position no one can argue with. The preparation is the negotiation.

BrightWork has served Lamorinda since 1977. Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Ben Olsen | (925) 255-9727 | ben@brightworkrealty.com | brightworkrealty.com

Not Every Home Needs a Public Launch.

For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or a different kind of timing — BrightWork has a smarter first step.

Most agents know one approach: list on the MLS, hit the portals, hold open houses. That works for many homes. For sellers who need privacy, flexibility, or more control over timing, BrightWork offers a structured, documented private path to the right buyer — built on relationships in Lamorinda that go back to 1977.

OFF MARKET SELLING HAS ITS BENEFITS

Your Home, Your Timing, No Pressure

No days-on-market counter. No public record. No nosy neighbors. Your home stays entirely private until you choose otherwise, and if you do go public later, you start fresh, with a clean slate and zero wasted days behind you.

Buyers Who Are Actually Ready

BrightWork maintains a curated list of serious, pre-qualified Bay Area buyers who have asked to be notified about Lamorinda properties. They are not browsing Zillow. Every showing is by appointment, with someone who qualifies and is genuinely interested.

Real Feedback Before You Commit

An off-market phase gives you genuine buyer response before you decide whether to close privately or step into a full MLS campaign. Either way, you move forward with real data and momentum, not day-one guesswork.

BrightWork's network of private buyers and collaborative realtor relationships has served Lamorinda since 1977.

Over \$1 billion in local real estate sold.

Deep relationships in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda.

WHO THE PRIVATE PATH SERVES

The Privacy-First Seller

No public listings, no open houses, and no days-on-market counter visible to buyers and agents, for whatever reason, professional or personal.

The Seller Still Preparing

Test genuine demand while staging or repairs are still underway, without burning days on market before you are ready.

The Strategically Timed Seller

Your next move depends on how this one closes. Control the sequence rather than react to a public countdown clock.

The Seller Testing the Waters

Get real buyer feedback before committing to a full public launch — or decide you do not need one at all.

Your home. Your timeline. Your terms.

Ready to find out whether the private path is the right first step?

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